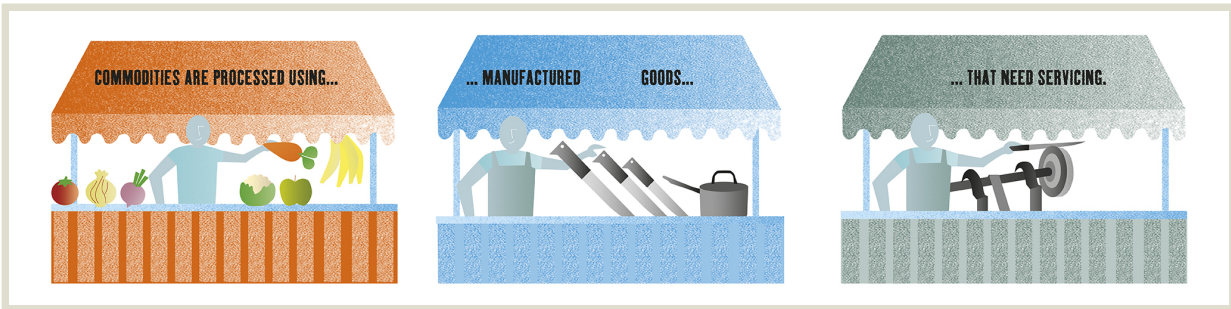




Goods and services

Providers of all kinds of goods and services sell their products by offering them on the market. Buyers can choose from a range of often connected commodities, manufactured goods, and services.

Something special

There are also markets that specialize in one kind of product. In coastal towns, for example, there is often a fish market. The goods at specialized markets aren't usually sold to the general public, but to people who will process the food in some way. For example, a farmer may sell his crop of corn to a miller who grinds it to make flour. It's not only agricultural produce that's sold in these specialized markets. Just as fish markets and corn exchanges emerged from the general marketplace, so did markets to exchange goods like iron, coal, and diamonds—often in industrial cities and ports.

Buying and selling

Together, all the goods that are sold in these specialized markets are known as commodities, and are sold in specific commodity markets. The goods in these markets, which range from coffee and tea to metals and plastics, are usually sold in large quantities, and aren't physically taken to the market—instead, this is simply a place where traders meet to agree on a price and make a deal. Often, the traders aren't buying and selling for themselves, but selling on behalf of producers such as farmers, or buying on behalf of industries that process the goods in some way, such as food-processing companies. In all these different kinds of market, whether it's a simple market stall, a department store, or a commodity market, the principle of buying and selling is the same. They provide a means of distributing resources, and a way of